

EXHIBIT D

Donnie Oliveira
Deputy City Administrator
Community & Economic Development
City of Portland
1120 SW 5th Ave
Portland OR 97204

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Dear DCA Oliveira,

Thank you for the opportunity to serve on the Steering Committee for the Future of Large-Scale Performing Arts project. We have weighed the technical, economic, social, philanthropic, and cultural dimensions of the important choices the City faces. Please accept this letter which outlines our collective vision and recommendations as the City makes critical decisions related to Portland's cultural ecosystem and economy.

A Vision for Transformative Impact

The steering committee's unanimous recommendation sets forth a cohesive vision for the transformation of performing arts in Portland. We support the pairing of a bold, creative investment in the new Portland State University Performing Arts + Culture Center along with civic stewardship and reinvention of the Keller Auditorium and/or site. Together, the investments will protect the economic engine of Broadway touring productions, support nonprofit arts organizations, strengthen the academic mission of Portland State University (PSU) and revitalize a key area of downtown Portland that includes the historic Ira Keller Fountain and Portland Open Space Sequence. By acting decisively now, the City can seize a once-in-a-generation opportunity to build a performing arts ecosystem that is more resilient, inclusive, and vibrant.

Recommendation

Build a new Broadway-capable venue as part of the proposed Performing Arts + Culture Center at Portland State University (PSU). Simultaneously, create an actionable plan to reimagine the Keller Auditorium and/or site based on Portland's historic, cultural, and civic values in accordance with passionate public support expressed by the community.

This unanimous committee recommendation supports a forward-thinking vision that expands the arts ecosystem and redefines Portland's place on the nation's cultural map for generations to come.

A New Broadway-Capable Venue at PSU

After comprehensive review, the steering committee's recommended approach avoids the catastrophic economic and employment impacts that would accompany a multi-year Keller

Auditorium shutdown—estimated at two years of closure and 3–5 years without touring Broadway shows. These losses would be an extremely difficult recovery for Portland’s arts ecosystem and downtown businesses.

Although considered by the committee, a temporary venue is not a viable option if the Keller is renovated to continue as a Broadway-capable facility. There are no existing venues in Portland or proven temporary venue models that could meet the needs of Broadway-scale seating capacity, audience experience, and technical requirements.

In contrast, PSU’s proposed complex delivers substantial immediate and long-term advantages. PSU already holds \$157.6 million in committed funding from the State of Oregon, Prosper Portland, and private donors, with potential for further philanthropic investment due to the project’s scale and ambition. It will also leverage substantial private investment. The project meets the city’s need for a large modern auditorium, while enhancing the university’s academic mission and advancing training in all aspects of the performing arts. The new complex will also provide essential affordable rehearsal and performance space for small arts organizations—an ongoing gap in the city’s arts infrastructure. PSU has a stated intent to raise funds for this supportive role and for long term maintenance.

The Essential Future of the Keller Auditorium

The committee emphasizes in the strongest possible terms that the City must not allow the Keller Auditorium to sit unused or deteriorate but rather be reimaged and continue to provide public benefit. Its location, cultural significance, and relationship to the Keller Fountain make it a uniquely valuable civic asset. The site links to the existing cultural institutions and open spaces along the Broadway-South Park Blocks corridor and to new destinations such as the James Beard Public Market and Performing Arts + Culture Center. Furthermore, given its seismic condition, investment is mandatory even if it is not redeveloped as a large-scale theater.

Multiple ideas have emerged from community and stakeholder feedback. While the steering committee does not endorse a single option, it unanimously recommends that the City begin an inclusive and immediate process to explore a major public space that honors the arts, the cultural landscape, and has public benefits. That process should include a committee to study options and budget, and community engagement to explore future concepts for the Keller Auditorium and/or site. The goal is to ensure that a plan is ready to implement when the new PSU theater opens.

Additional Considerations

Operating Agreements and Civic Accountability

A new venue at PSU represents a major shift in Portland’s performing arts ecosystem. Currently, the Keller Auditorium functions as a financial engine for Portland’s, subsidizing other venues used heavily by nonprofit arts organizations. To ensure continued system-wide financial stability, the committee recommends a formal operating agreement between the City and PSU that secures a dedicated funding stream from PSU venue revenues to support Portland’s and

the broader arts sector. In addition, the committee recommends PSU and the City develop strategies to expand and grow public and private investments in Portland's arts organizations and cultural corridors.

Because the City and State will be major funders of the new facility, they also bear responsibility for establishing development criteria that maximize public benefit and ensure the interests of Portland's performing arts community are incorporated into the facility's design and operations.

Touring Broadway Partnership

Portland is a high-performing and important market for touring Broadway producers. Given the significant public and private investments planned to ensure uninterrupted Broadway programming, the committee encourages PSU and the City to explore opportunities for touring Broadway producers to contribute financially to the Performing Arts + Culture Center and the ecosystem it will support. The City may have reasonable leverage to request such a partnership.

Call to Action

It is imperative that the City move forward in the most expeditious manner and commit the staff resources necessary to implement the committee's recommendation.

Sincerely,

Brad Demby, RA, Brad Demby Architect

Brianna McCoy, Saturday Academy

Carl Abbott, Author, Urban Historian

Carol Mayer-Reed, FASLA, Founding Partner Emeritus, Mayer/Reed

Christopher McVoy, Co-founder, O'Neill McVoy Architects and Partner Emeritus Steven Holl Architects

Edwina Kane, Portland Center Stage

Helen Ying, Community and Cultural Leader

Jim Brunberg, Mississippi Studios, Revolution Hall

Lynda Moss, Moss Consulting

Nick Schwartz-Hall, Independent Producer

Sara Vonde Veld, Oregon Health & Science University